

PLATFORM 4 – SOUTHBOUND

CGV GROUP PROJECT · CONCEPT PITCH

COMS3006A / COMS3025A · THREE.JS · 3 LEVELS

PROPOSAL FOR THE GROUP – READ THIS, THEN VOTE

BLACKOUT PROTOCOL

An endless-chase thriller where the chase changes shape twice.
You run. Then you drive. Then you stop running and turn
around.

01

RUN

DOWNLINE · THE METRO

02

DRIVE

REDLINE · THE HIGHWAY

03

FIGHT

DEEPHOLD · THE MINE

THE IDEA IN ONE LINE

SAME CHASE. THREE DIFFERENT GAMES.

The brief asks a hard question of every level: what does this level do that the others do not? Most groups answer it with new scenery. We answer it with a new verb — the thing your hands are actually doing changes twice, and the story is what makes the change make sense.



01

RUN

DOWNLINE · FLOODED METRO TUNNELS UNDER THE CITY AT 02:00.

Three lanes, jump, slide. He is fifteen metres behind you and he never gets tired. You cannot hurt him and he cannot reach you — every mistake just closes the gap.

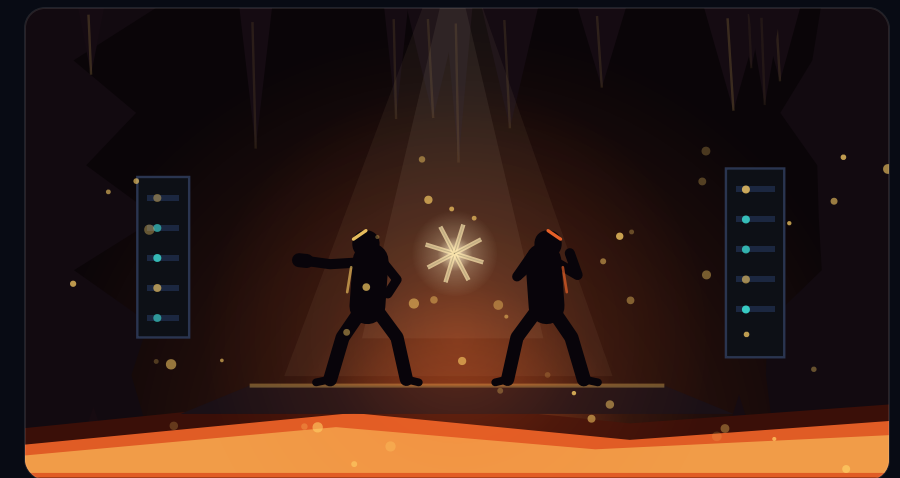


02

DRIVE

REDLINE · SIX LANES OF HIGHWAY OUT OF THE CITY, SUNSET INTO NIGHT.

Now you have a vehicle, and for the first time he can hurt you. He rams, he shoots your tyres, he drops drones. A health bar appears. Mistakes now cost damage, not distance.



03

FIGHT

DEEPHOLD · A DEAD GOLD MINE, 900 M DOWN, LIT BY LAVA FISSURES.

The corridor ends. There is nowhere left to run and the game stops being a runner — free movement, lock-on, dodge, parry, and a three-phase boss who finally takes the helmet off.

If a marker asks “what is new in level two?” the answer is one word, and they can see it from across the room.

THE STORYLINE

YOU WERE NEVER SUPPOSED TO READ THAT FILE.

PROLOGUE · THE NIGHT MIGRATION

You are Kai Ndlovu, 24, a junior systems engineer on a routine overnight job at a private data centre. At 01:48 a rack you were told was decommissioned finishes an integrity check and spills a manifest onto your screen: BLACKOUT — a continent-wide network kill switch, already contracted, delivery in nine days. You copy the key onto a shielded drive, because you cannot think of a single good reason it should exist. You get twelve steps down the corridor before the door behind you opens.



THE OBJECT

THE KEY

A shielded drive holding the master decryption key for BLACKOUT. On your back in level one, bolted into the car in level two, and in your fist in level three.

THE ANTAGONIST

THE HANDLER

One man, three silhouettes. On foot he is a shape at the edge of the tunnel lights. On the road he is headlights and muzzle flash. In the mine he is a face — and it belongs to the person who signed you onto the contract six months ago. That reveal is the reason the third level exists.

THE EPILOGUE

ELEVEN MORE

The upload finishes and the helmet comes off. Then a phone lights up with something else you were never meant to read: there are eleven other keys.

ACT I



DOWNLINE

The cameras own the street, so you go under it. The metro is closed, flooded, and not empty.

INTERLUDE I



THE GATE

You make it through the sector seal. He does not. Then he starts climbing.

ACT II



REDLINE

A contact waits past the toll. He never arrives — because he never left the building.

INTERLUDE II



THE FALL

He rams you off a mountain bridge. You wake on a riverbank facing a dead mine.

ACT III



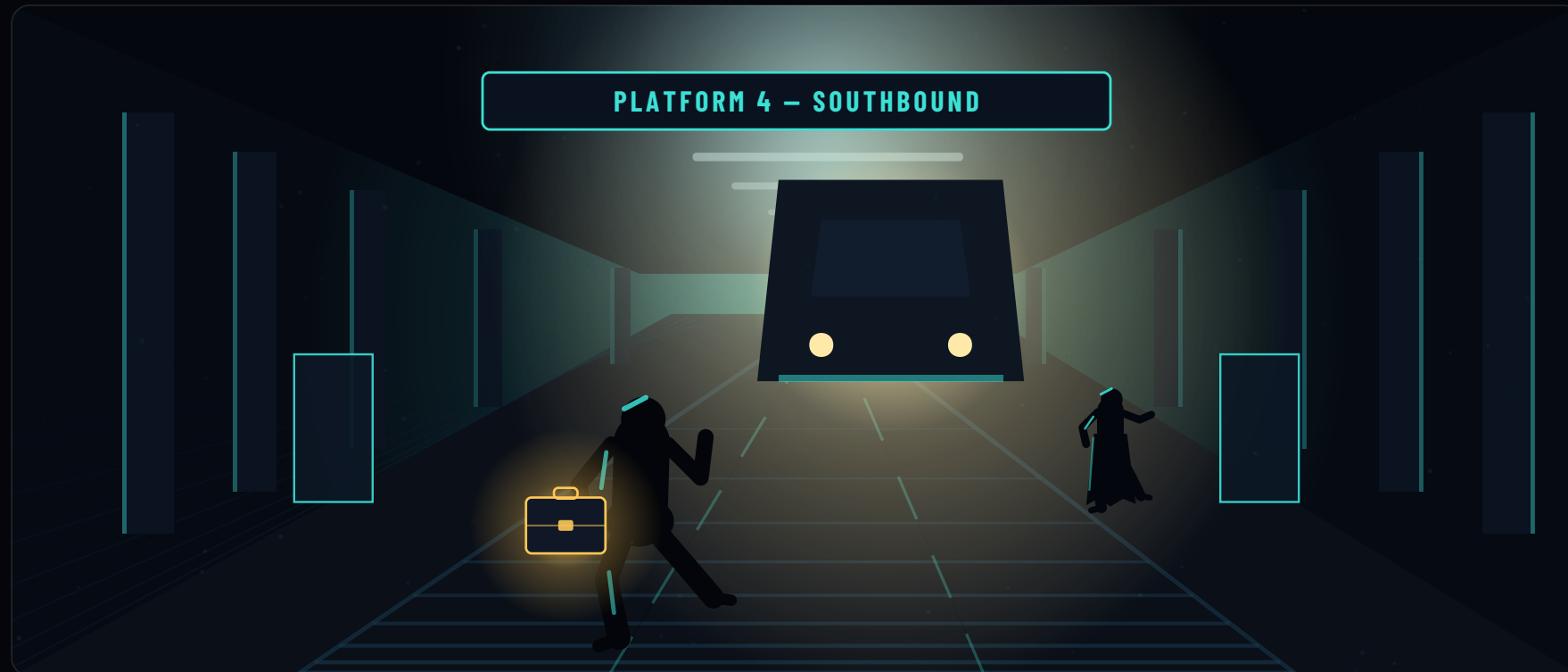
DEEPHOLD

The vault has an uplink. Publish the key and the switch is worthless. He is in the way.

LEVEL 01 · DOWNLINE

RUN DOWNLINE

Rosebank interchange, 02:14. The metro is closed, half-flooded, and lit by whatever emergency strips still work. Behind you is a man in a coat who has not once broken stride.



3

LANES

4 min

FIRST CLEAN RUN

15 m

HIS HEAD START

3

LETTERS HIDDEN

He does not run faster than you. He just never slows down.

DESIGN PILLAR — LEVEL 01

RUBRIC THIS LEVEL PAYS FOR

HIERARCHICAL MODELLING · THIRD-PERSON CHASE CAM · LOOK-BACK CAMERA · SHADOW-CASTING HEADLIGHT · REFLECTIVE WET FLOOR · SPEED-WARP SHADER · CHUNK STREAMING

WHERE YOU ARE

Wet concrete and cyan emergency light. Service tunnels under the CBD — turnstiles, dead escalators, a live third rail, and the 02:20 southbound coming the other way. Cold cyan and steel, amber only where something is about to hurt you.

WHAT THIS LEVEL DOES THAT THE OTHERS DO NOT

- Establishes the core runner loop: three lanes, jump, slide, don't stop.
- The pursuer cannot reach you and you cannot fight back — the only currency is distance. Every clipped barrier hands him three metres.
- Teaches the Signal system: letters on the track, departure boards overhead.

CONTROLS

A / D change lane

SPACE vault / jump

CTRL slide under

MOUSE camera swing + look back

SHIFT sprint burst (cooldown)

WHAT WILL KILL YOU

oncoming train · third rail · ticket barriers · luggage trolleys · closing sector gates · ceiling ducts · flooded trackbed

FAIL STATE — HE CATCHES YOU, OR THE SOUTHBOUND DOES

THE GATE CLOSES BETWEEN YOU.

This is not a loading screen with a paragraph on it. It is the last fifteen seconds of the level, played — and the camera is only taken away from you at the exact moment you win. Then the card. Then the thing that ruins the card.

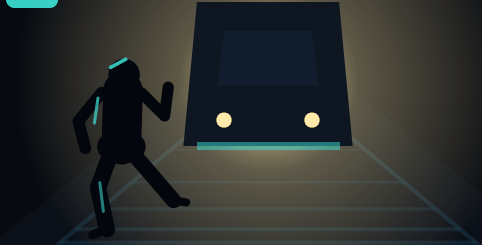
1



THE SUBWAY SPLITS

The tunnel forks. One side is dark, one side is lit — and you have about a second to pick.

2



A TRAIN IS COMING

Headlights fill the tunnel you chose. There is no room on the trackbed for both of you.

3



A HUGE GATE AHEAD

A sector seal is grinding shut at the end of the platform. The gap is getting shorter.

4



YOU JUMP — AT THE LAST SECOND

Slide under the seal with the train at your heels. Camera drops low, time stretches, audio cuts to a heartbeat.

5



HE DOESN'T MAKE IT

The seal locks. He hits it a beat too late, and the two of you look at each other through the bars.

ON SCREEN

LEVEL COMPLETE

"You escaped the subway... but he's still coming."

PRESS SPACE TO CONTINUE

WHY THE TRANSITION MATTERS

The card holds for two seconds and then the camera pulls back through the bars — and he is already climbing over the gate. The player exhales, and then doesn't. That single shot is what makes level two feel earned instead of assigned.

- Costs almost nothing: one scripted camera path, two animation clips, no new systems.
- Carries the story forward without a single line of exposition.
- Directly targets Gameplay & Experience — 25% of the mark, and the biggest single block on the rubric.

LEVEL 02 · REDLINE

DRIVE REDLINE

The N3 out of the city, sunset bleeding into night. Six lanes, freight trucks, a toll plaza and rain on the way. He has stopped chasing you politely.



6

LANES OF TRAFFIC

4

ATTACK TYPES

100%

CAR INTEGRITY TO LOSE

2

SKIES: DUSK, NIGHT

Level one taught you that mistakes cost distance. Level two teaches you that mistakes now cost paint, then panels, then the car.

DESIGN PILLAR — LEVEL 02

RUBRIC THIS LEVEL PAYS FOR

DYNAMIC SKYBOX · MULTIPLE DYNAMIC LIGHTS · WET-ROAD REFLECTIONS · RAIN SHADER · MOTION BLUR / POST-PROCESSING · ORTHOGRAPHIC MINIMAP · PICTURE-IN-PICTURE · VEHICLE PHYSICS

WHERE YOU ARE

Open highway leaving the skyline behind — magenta dusk turning to black, sodium streetlights, wet tarmac, headlights. The sky changes across the level, so the level looks different at the end than it did at the start.

WHAT THIS LEVEL DOES THAT THE OTHERS DO NOT

- You are in a vehicle: momentum, drift, boost and a heat gauge replace jump and slide.
- THE CHASER CAN NOW HURT YOU. He rams, PITs you, shoots out tyres and drops drones. A health bar exists for the first time.
- New camera language: rear-view picture-in-picture showing him closing, plus an orthographic minimap of the traffic ahead.

CONTROLS

W / S throttle / brake

A / D steer

SPACE handbrake drift

SHIFT boost (heat-limited)

MOUSE free look + mirror cam

WHAT WILL KILL YOU

ramming attacks · tyre shots · spike strips · chase drones · freight trucks · roadworks · toll booms · jack-knifed tanker

FAIL STATE — THE CAR IS DESTROYED

THERE IS NOTHING LEFT TO RUN TO.

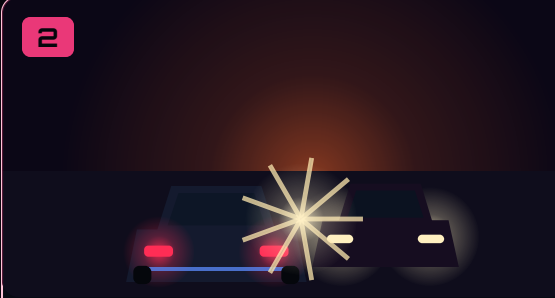
Level two ends by taking the car away from you — the only honest way to end a driving level that is followed by a fight. You lose the vehicle, the road, the sky and the escape route in one continuous shot.



1

THE MOUNTAIN PASS

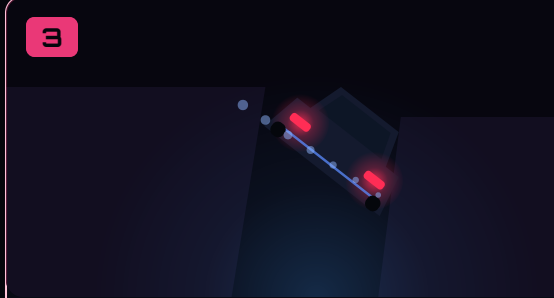
The highway climbs out of the basin. One bridge, no shoulder, and his headlights filling your mirror.



2

HE COMMITS

No more warning shots. He rams you at speed on the bridge deck — the last attack of level two is the one that connects.



3

OVER THE EDGE

The car goes through the barrier and down into the ravine. Cut to black on impact with the water.



4

SHAFT 7

You come round on the riverbank, the Key still in your hand, staring at the adit of a dead gold mine cut into the rock.



5

YOU STOP RUNNING

Torchlight behind you in the tunnel. There is nowhere else to go, so you put the Key down and turn around.

ON SCREEN

LEVEL COMPLETE

"You got off the road. Now there's only down."

PRESS SPACE TO CONTINUE

WHY THE TRANSITION MATTERS

The billboard at the mine entrance does the last piece of work for us: SHAFT 7 — DECOMMISSIONED — DO NOT DESCEND. The player descends anyway, and the game changes genre on the other side of that sign.

- Removes the vehicle diegetically, so level three's controls are a story event and not a settings change.
- Hands us the environment swap for free — night highway to lava-lit rock is the biggest visual jump in the game.
- Sets the final question: he is between you and the uplink, and this time he is not behind you.

FIGHT DEEPHOLD

Nine hundred metres down a dead gold mine, in a chamber somebody filled with servers and left off the map. Geothermal heat, lava fissures, and one man between you and the uplink.



3

BOSS PHASES

1

ARENA, SHRINKING

6 min

FIGHT LENGTH

0

PLACES LEFT TO RUN

Every runner ends the same way: the level stops and a number goes up. Ours ends with the thing that has been chasing you for twenty minutes standing still, close enough to hit.

DESIGN PILLAR — LEVEL 03

RUBRIC THIS LEVEL PAYS FOR

CUSTOM LAVA + HEAT-HAZE SHADER · EMISSIVE LIGHTING · TOON / OUTLINE SHADER · DISSOLVE SHADER · NORMAL + HEIGHT MAPPED ROCK · DYNAMIC SHADOWS · FIRST-PERSON SCAN VIEW · PARTICLES

WHERE YOU ARE

Raw rock lit from below by lava, with black server monoliths bolted straight into the walls and cooling steam venting through the cracks. Everything is orange, black and sweat — the exact opposite of the cold blue metro you started in.

WHAT THIS LEVEL DOES THAT THE OTHERS DO NOT

- The chase inverts. Forward-only movement is gone; this is a free 3D arena with lock-on, stamina, dodge and parry.
- You can finally hurt him. Three boss phases — Pursuit, Stand, Desperation — and in phase two the helmet comes off and the story lands.
- The arena fights you too: the floor collapses into the fissure as the fight goes on, so the space shrinks while the enemy gets faster.

CONTROLS

W A S D	free movement	MOUSE L	light / heavy attack
MOUSE R	block, then parry	SPACE	dodge roll
E	vent steam / drop rock	0	the Key — slow-mo pulse

WHAT WILL KILL YOU

the Handler · lava fissures · collapsing platform · steam vents · falling rock · his phase-3 rush

FAIL STATE — HEALTH DEPLETES, OR THE FLOOR DOES

THE SIGNAL SYSTEM

HOW THE PLAYER FINDS OUT WHAT'S GOING ON.

Two channels of environmental storytelling, both cheap to build and both running the whole game. One is quiet and optional. One is loud and unmissable. Between them the player gets the entire plot without a single cutscene interrupting a run.

A



CHANNEL A – THE LETTERS

A dead-drop envelope or data shard on the route. Grab it mid-run and a card slides into the HUD corner with one line on it. Nothing pauses.

B



CHANNEL B – THE BOARDS

Departure boards, highway gantries, mine safety signs — diegetic, enormous, announcing your progress in the language of the place you are in.

NINE LETTERS, THREE PER LEVEL

- Three per level, hidden slightly off the safe line — you take a risk to read the story.
- All three in a level unlocks a lore terminal and the true ending, which is exactly the “replay value” the rubric asks for by name.
- Implementation is a trigger volume and a HUD card. One system, nine strings, no new tech.

WHAT THE LETTERS SAY

LEVEL 01

- “They told you that rack was decommissioned. It was signed for on Tuesday.”
- “Twelve names on the manifest. Yours is the only one still breathing.”
- “He isn't chasing the drive. He's chasing you.”

LEVEL 02

- “Your contact never left the building.”
- “You were selected six months ago. The job was the interview.”
- “The mine isn't a hiding place. It's an address.”

LEVEL 03

- “You were meant to find it.”
- “He wrote your recruitment letter. Compare the handwriting.”
- “Eleven more keys. Eleven more of you.”

BOARDS SHOUT: SECTOR 2 CLEAR · HE'S STILL COMING · NO SERVICE BEYOND THIS POINT · SHAFT 7 — DO NOT DESCEND

WHY THIS IS BUILDABLE IN THREE WEEKS

ONE ENGINE. THREE SKINS. ONE NEW SYSTEM.

The honest objection to this pitch is that it looks like three games. It isn't. Levels one and two are the same code path with a different top speed and a different prop set. Only level three adds genuinely new code — and level three is where the Innovation and Gameplay marks live.

CHUNK STREAMER

Spawns and recycles level segments from a pool ahead of the player and disposes behind. Written once for level 01; level 02 is the same class with longer chunks; level 03 reuses it for the collapsing floor.

PLAYER CONTROLLER

One state machine. Lane-snap mode (L1) becomes steering mode (L2) becomes free-arena mode (L3). Same input layer, same camera rig, three profiles.

PURSUER

Distance-driven state machine. L1 has two states (gain, close). L2 adds four attack states. L3 swaps in a combat FSM with three phases.

SIGNAL SYSTEM

A trigger volume feeds a HUD card, plus a text-quad shader for the boards. Level-agnostic, nine lines of content.

SHADER LIBRARY

speed-warp · lava + heat haze · rain-on-glass · dissolve · outline. Written as reusable ShaderMaterials, one owner.

SHELL

Menu, pause, options, restart-without-reload, loading screen, credits. Built in week one so it is never the thing we are doing at 3am.

WHAT ACTUALLY DIFFERS BETWEEN LEVEL 01 AND LEVEL 02

CHANGE	COST
Geometry	swap the chunk prefab set
Lighting	swap the light rig + skybox
Speed	one number
Pursuer	enable the attack states
HUD	add a health bar

THE ONE REAL RISK, NAMED

Level three's combat is the only unknown in this plan. So we greybox it in week two — capsules, no art, hit detection and three phases — not in week four. If it is fun as capsules it will be spectacular in a lava-lit cave. If it isn't, we still have five days to simplify it into a chase-and-corner encounter and nobody loses a level.

THE RUBRIC, LINE BY LINE

WHERE EVERY MARK COMES FROM.

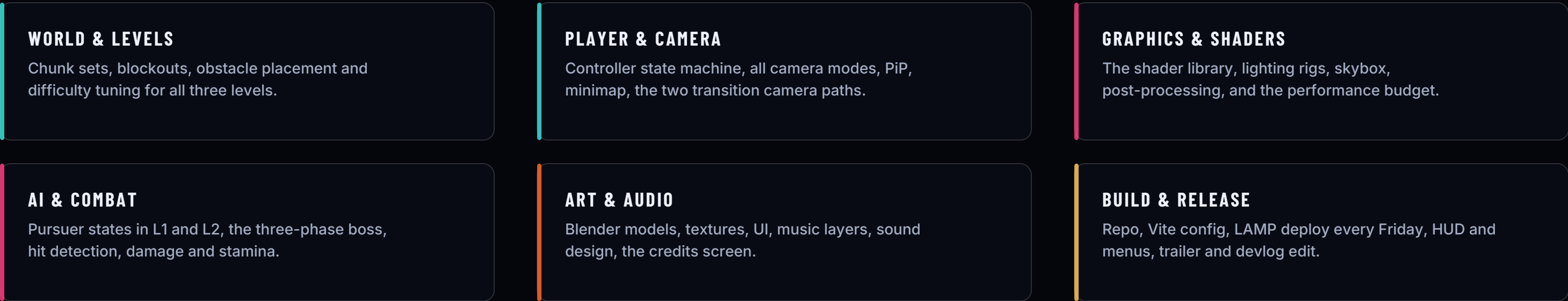
This is the slide that should decide the vote. Not “is it a cool idea” but “does it pay for all one hundred marks”.

CRITERION	WEIGHT	WHAT EARNS IT IN THIS GAME
Viewing	10%	Third-person chase cam · look-back camera (L1) · rear-view picture-in-picture and orthographic minimap (L2) · lock-on combat cam and first-person scan view (L3) · scripted cinematic paths on both transitions.
Control & Playability	10%	Keyboard and mouse throughout, three control profiles that escalate. Clear objective, clear win and loss in every level. Real physics: character controller, vehicle handling, melee impacts.
3D Effects	15%	Dynamic skybox across level 02 · shadow-casting train and car headlights · wet-floor and wet-road reflections · heat refraction over lava · normal and height maps on rock and concrete · antialiasing and depth of field.
Shaders	10%	Five custom ShaderMaterials, one per problem: speed-warp driven by a velocity uniform, animated lava with noise and heat haze, rain-on-glass, dissolve on despawn, outline in boss phase three. All time- or state-driven, none static.
Gameplay & Experience	25%	A three-act story with a reveal, two playable cinematic transitions, nine collectible letters, diegetic boards, a distinct palette and soundscape per level, and a true ending for collectors — replay value, by name.
Polish	10%	Menu, pause, options, restart without refreshing the page, loading screen with lore cards, per-level colour scheme, damage and speed HUD, adaptive music that layers as he closes in.
Innovation	10%	The verb shift itself · the pursuit picture-in-picture · the Signal system · custom Blender assets · chunk streaming with strict disposal · a genre change inside one game.
Game Trailer	10%	The three-verb structure is already a trailer edit: RUN in cyan, DRIVE in magenta, FIGHT in orange, then the title card. We shoot it from the beta build, not the night before.

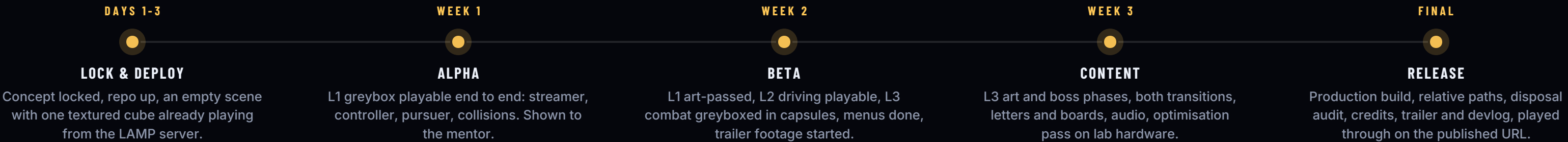
HOW WE RUN IT

SIX ROLES, THREE WEEKS, DEPLOY FROM DAY THREE.

Nobody owns “the game”. Everybody owns a system that has to exist in all three levels, which is what stops us building three separate prototypes that never merge.



THREE WEEKS TO THE GRADED BETA



THE PLAN SURVIVES CONTACT WITH A BAD WEEK.

Every group project dies the same way: the ambitious thing is left until last, it doesn't work, and the whole submission goes down with it. So here is the cut order, agreed now while nobody is panicking.

COMBAT IS THE UNKNOWN

Greybox it in week two. If it isn't fun as capsules, it becomes a chase-and-corner encounter with three scripted beats and we lose nothing structural.

PERFORMANCE ON LAB MACHINES

1024× textures max, merged geometry, one shadow-casting light per level, strict .dispose() on level teardown, and a frame counter in the build from week one.

DEPLOYMENT

Relative paths and base: './' from the first commit, lowercase hyphenated asset names, and a deploy to the server every Friday whether it is ready or not.

SCOPE CREEP

Three levels playable beats two levels beautiful. Nothing new goes in after the beta that isn't on the fix list.

CUT IN THIS ORDER, WITHOUT A MEETING

- Drone attacks in level 02 — the ram and the tyre shots already sell the threat.
- Boss phase three's collapsing arena — keep the phase, drop the geometry.
- The third letter in each level — six still tells the whole story.
- Rain-on-glass — the wet-road reflection carries the weather on its own.

NEVER CUT, UNDER ANY CIRCUMSTANCES

- Three levels playable start to finish from the hosted URL.
- One custom shader visible in every level, and every member able to explain it.
- Restart without refreshing the page.
- The credits screen, complete and honest.
- The trailer — it is ten per cent of the mark for two minutes of editing.

SO – ARE WE BUILDING THIS?

If we pick this today, nobody has to wonder what they are doing on Monday. The systems are named, the roles are named, the cut list is agreed and the first deploy is a textured cube.

01

VOTE THE CONCEPT

Three verbs, three environments, one antagonist.

02

CLAIM A SYSTEM

Six roles on page twelve. Pick one, own it end to end.

03

REPO TONIGHT

Vite + Three.js, base: './', and a cube on the server by Wednesday.

“

You escaped the subway... but he's still coming.

THE LINE THAT SELLS THE WHOLE GAME